

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examination 2024

RETHINKING MODERNITY

Time allowed: **THREE** hours

An open-book exam allows you to refer to your notes and other course materials while you are taking the exam. Open-book exams are designed to test your ability to analyse, evaluate or synthesise knowledge, rather than your ability to recall facts or information.

You may bring physical written or printed notes, textbooks, dictionaries or course materials into the exam room. Please note that your materials must fit on a small desk and you are advised to bring well-structured notes based on revision topics.

You may not bring electronic devices except calculators of the following types only: Casio FX-83GT or Casio FX-85GT series only (CW, X, PLUS). All Sociology exams will be paper-based and hand-written.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total. **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B**, and **ONE** other from **EITHER SECTION**.

The paper consists of **TWELVE** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator. Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room. Do not open the question paper until told to do so.

All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided.

All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided.

A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked.

At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.

Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total. **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B**, and **ONE** other from **EITHER SECTION**.

SECTION A

1. In what ways is modernity a colonial project?
2. Why is it important to study animals within sociology?
3. Discuss the links between language and inequality. How can sociologists help to address the problem?
4. Is ‘feminisms’ a better way to understand women’s experiences than ‘feminism?’
5. In what ways does the feminist epistemology overturn the canons and practices of traditional epistemology?
6. Why is it important to study elites in society?

END OF SECTION A

SECTION B

7. How does Foucault conceptualise disciplinary power? Why is this conceptualisation important?
8. “Contemporary societies are biopolitical.” Critically analyse this statement.
9. How did European modernity benefit from unequal race relations? Discuss with reference to the work of two theorists.
10. What is postcolonial theory? In what ways is it a critique of modernity?
11. What is a Southern theory? What are the limitations of the concept?
12. What is the ‘Anthropocene’? Is it an adequate concept to understand the links between climate crisis and capitalism?

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER